



INTERNAL · CAPITAL-RAISE MASTER PLAN

Equity Raise Plan

Dual-Track: US-Led + AU Family Offices + Fintech VCs. USD \$5M priced equity round.

ROUND USD \$5M priced equity · AU-domiciled

DATE May 2026

HONG KONG · SYDNEY · SAN FRANCISCO · LONDON · CHANNEL ISLANDS

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Last updated: 2026-05-04 **Round structure:** Pre-Series A SAFE round – post-money SAFE, uncapped valuation, **30% discount** to the Qualifying Round (Series A Growth Equity Round, scheduled 2028). **Minimum investment USD \$1M.** Discount **reduces progressively** as each SAFE is issued. Side letter for follow-on / pro-rata. MFN terms. No lead. Rolling close. Sits alongside USD \$10M of existing convertible / SAFE notes from a prior tranche at \$85M val cap. **Currency:** USD-denominated (AUD parallel sub-tranche on the same SAFE terms for ESVCLP-qualifying AU investors) **Series A:** Growth Equity Round, **scheduled 2028.** Target valuation deliberately not published externally – investors model their own. **Timeline:** 4–6 months from kick-off to substantive completion (rolling close means commitments draw progressively) **Corporate domicile:** Australia (Futureproof Financial Group Limited) **Capital-raise leadership:** US capital-raise effort run by **Mike Spidaliere (FTFC)** and **Max Goldberg (Gold Capital Consulting)**; AU/global outreach co-ordinated by John R Innes (Co-Founder & Executive Director) **Audience:** US strategics, family offices, and fintech-specialist VCs (primary track via Mike + Max); AU family offices (parallel track via John); fintech / insurtech-specialist VCs (global) + strategic backups (super funds, Challenger, Munich Re, Apollo, etc.)

Resume Here

State as of 2026-05-04: Pre-launch (Phase 0). Full investor pack built across both tracks (FO + VC). Ready to open Phase 1 outreach.

What's been decided

- **Capital type:** SAFE
- **Corporate domicile:** Australia (Futureproof Financial Group Limited)
- **Capital-raise leadership:** Mike Spidaliere + Max Goldberg run the US effort; John Innes co-ordinates AU/global
- **Audience:** Dual-track. **US strategics + family offices + fintech-specialist VCs** is the primary track (run by Mike + Max). **AU family offices** is the parallel track (run by John). Generalist VCs deprioritised but not excluded if a strong warm path exists.
- **Round shape:** Pre-Series A **SAFE** round (post-money, uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028, USD \$1M minimum cheque, rolling close, no lead, MFN, side letter for follow-on/pro-rata). Sits alongside existing convertible / SAFE notes (USD \$10M with \$85M valuation cap from a prior tranche).
- **SAFE rationale:** speed, low legal cost, pricing event is the Series A 2028. The decreasing-discount mechanic creates urgency without high-pressure tactics.
- **ESVCLP:** Available for qualifying AU investors via AUD parallel sub-tranche on the same SAFE terms. Not the leading frame.
- **Narrative frame (different per audience):**

- **For FOs:** human story → asset class → unit economics
- **For VCs:** market structure → **AI-native operating model** → defensibility → unit economics → exit path → human story (as proof, not lede)
- **AI positioning:** AI-native company, but framed as **operating leverage**, not as the product. Specifics in the "AI-native operations" section below. Avoid AI-washing – VCs punish it harder than they reward it.

Why dual-track now (and the honest tradeoff)

Adding the VC track widens the funnel and materially improves Series A optionality if a fintech-specialist anchors or co-invests. **The cost is discipline:** generalist VCs will pattern-match this against SaaS comps, lose interest fast, and burn future-round bridges if pitched now. Mitigation = strict targeting (see "Which VCs to approach" below) + **upfront disclosure of the issues that make this a hard sell for a typical fund**. Let them say no fast rather than waste their time and ours.

What's in this folder

- `PLAN.md` – this file. Phase plan + gates + dual-track positioning.
- `teaser.md` – 1-page pre-NDA narrative (FO variant, human-story-led).
- `teaser_vc.md` – 1-page pre-NDA narrative (VC variant, market-structure-led).
- `target_list.md` – Tier 1/2/3/4 named targets with status columns.
- `warm_intro_templates.md` / `outreach_pack.md` – email templates + phone scripts (FO + VC variants).
- `ai_architecture.md` – VC-pack one-pager (live / built / roadmap / never).
- `faq.md` – 26 pre-empted objections incl. VC-specific (fund math, time-to-exit, regulatory, comp set).
- `valuation_analysis.md` – **internal only**, not investor-facing.

Next 3 actions (do these before any outreach)

1. Confirm ESVCLP eligibility status (or apply). Material to FOs; neutral-to-positive for VCs.
2. Engage AU venture lawyer for SAFE template + side-letter template.
3. Build the warm-intro graph in `target_list.md` for FOs and fintech-specialist VC partners.

Decision gates

Gate	Threshold	When
End Phase 1	2+ credible early-conviction candidates (US strategic / FO / VC) at the higher discount tier	Wk 7
End Phase 2	First SAFE signed at ≥ USD \$1M	Wk 14
End Phase 3	Substantive SAFE momentum – multiple SAFEs in, discount tier stepped at least once	Wk 20
End Phase 4	Round substantively complete (capital drawn under rolling close)	Wk 24

Folder index

File	Purpose
<code>PLAN.md</code>	This file. The master plan and decision gates.
<code>teaser.md</code>	1-page narrative, sent pre-NDA to open doors (FO variant).
<code>teaser_vc.md</code>	Market-structure-led 1-pager for VC partners.
<code>target_list.md</code>	Tier 1 / 2 / 3 / 4 named targets with status tracking.
<code>warm_intro_templates.md</code>	Email templates for intros, follow-ups, references (FO + VC variants).
<code>deck_outline.md</code>	15-slide deck structure with key message per slide (FO + VC variants).
<code>faq.md</code>	Top investor objections, pre-empted answers.

Honest disclosure for VCs (lead with this; share verbatim if asked)

We expect the partner-meeting question: "*why isn't this a SaaS deal?*" Answer it upfront. The following are real reasons EPM is a hard sell for many VC funds. We list them not to talk past them but so a partner can disqualify in 10 minutes if it's not a fit, instead of 6 weeks.

1. Fund-return math. EPM economics resemble specialty insurance / asset management more than SaaS. Steady-state EBITDA margin profile is attractive (74% Y3 → 89% Y5 blended on the fee streams; we don't warehouse risk) – but the path to a 10-50× equity outcome depends on platform AUM growth and an eventual strategic / IPO exit, not multiple expansion on ARR. 3-case Y5 revenue spread: \$162M / \$633M / \$2.46B (USD). For SAFE pricing the binding event is Series A 2028 – investors convert at a 30% discount to whatever clears. If your fund needs every position to plausibly return the fund on its own at conversion price, this isn't your deal.

2. Time to outcome. A retirement-income platform compounds slowly. Realistic exit window is 7-10 years (super-fund-led acquisition, Challenger-type strategic, or IPO). Doesn't fit a 5-year-from-investment exit assumption.

3. Capital intensity & funding-stack dependency. We need wholesale funder partners or warehouse facilities to write volume. We do not warehouse risk on our own balance sheet – but the model requires a credible funding stack and that takes time to build. This is closer to a fintech-marketplace + capital-markets play than a pure software business.

4. Regulatory surface area. ASIC (AU); FCA-equivalent regimes if we expand. The Retirement Income Covenant is a tailwind, but it doesn't shorten the licensing or compliance lift.

5. Mixed comp set. UK equity-release names (Just Group, Pure Retirement) have had bumpy public histories. Australian comps are sparse. A skeptical analyst will pull up Just's chart and the conversation gets harder. Our differentiator is a fundamentally different product structure – run-off mechanism, no arrears / no redraw mechanics, investment-linked income – but this needs explaining, and a 5-minute pattern-match goes against us.

6. Market education burden. Both borrowers and super funds need education. Sales cycle is quarters for super-fund integrations, months for direct-to-consumer. Not a viral / PLG curve.

7. AI is operating leverage, not a moat we're claiming. We are AI-native in how we run the business (see next section). We do **not** claim AI gives us a credit-underwriting edge, regulatory shortcut, or investment-return advantage. It lets a small team run a regulated financial services business at software-company overhead – that's the real claim, and we don't stretch it further.

If any of the above is a hard veto for your fund, please say so on the first call. We'd rather close the loop fast than burn 4 weeks of process. We're raising from people for whom these tradeoffs are *features* (regulated tailwind, defensible product, durable cashflows) – not bugs.

Which VCs to approach (and which not to)

Tier A – fintech / insurtech / longevity specialists (approach)

Specialist funds with mandates that match. Names below are starting points to verify against current fund vintage / mandate before outreach:

- **Square Peg** – fintech mandate, AU-led, regulated-fintech precedent (Athena).
- **AirTree** – fintech-comfortable; engages on the AU institutional / super-fund angle.
- **Blackbird** – generalist with regulated-bet history; only via portfolio-founder warm intro.
- **Anthemis (London)** – insurtech / longevity is core thesis. Best international fit.
- **QED Investors (US/UK)** – fintech specialist; lending / mortgage-adjacent track record. Higher bar.
- **Reinventure** (if active) – strategic-adjacent.
- **NAB Ventures / ANZi** (if active) – strategic, slow.

Tier B – generalist (approach only on warm intro, only with sharpened deck)

- Blackbird (above), Five V, OIF Ventures – only via portfolio-founder intro.

Tier C – do not approach now (wrong fit, burns relationship)

- Pure SaaS / consumer-app generalists – wrong comps.
- Seed funds <A\$50M AUM – cheque + fund-return math don't work.
- Crypto / Web3-thematic funds – wrong audience.

A "no" from a Tier-A VC is rarely real – most named funds raise a new vehicle every 2-3 years and the story will be stronger by then. Keep them on a quarterly update list; do not over-share materials in the first conversation.

What we share, and when

Stage	FO	VC
First call	Teaser (FO), narrative, model summary	Teaser (VC), market structure, comp set, honest-disclosure block above
2nd meeting	Full deck, financial model, regulatory status	Full deck, financial model, channel / customer proof
Diligence	Data room, references	Data room, references, model under NDA

The thesis (use this as your pitch frame)

For FOs

Family office principals are typically 50–75. They've watched a parent run out of liquid retirement savings while sitting on a \$2M home. They get this product viscerally in 90 seconds – which generalist VCs never do. **Pitch the human story first, the asset class second, the unit economics third.** Most founders do this in reverse and lose them.

For VCs

Lead with **market structure, not the human story**. The unlock is the **Retirement Income Covenant** (2022) – a regulated A\$3.5T tailwind that legally requires every super fund to have a retirement income strategy. Most still don't have a credible answer. The Callaghan Review (2020) explicitly endorsed home equity release. EPM is the turnkey solution super funds can offer their members. This is a B2B2C distribution play with a defensible product structure (run-off mechanism, no arrears / redraw, investment-linked) and a clear path to platform AUM economics. After market structure, show the **AI-native operating model** (next section) – that's the line that turns the conversation from "interesting financial product" to "venture-scale". *Then* unit economics. *Then* the human story (as proof of demand, not as the lede).

AI-native operations (the operating-leverage story for VCs)

The claim, stated narrowly: A small team (~[N] FTE) runs the end-to-end operations of a regulated financial services business – origination, customer service, marketing, compliance ops, investment management ops – at software-company cost structure, because the platform is built AI-native from day one.

The claim, stated honestly: AI does *not* underwrite credit decisions, replace human compliance sign-off, or generate investment alpha. It removes the cost of the work *around* those things – the 70% of FS-company headcount that is process, content, triage, support, and analytics, not regulated decision-making.

Where AI is genuinely doing work in the platform today

- **Customer-facing agent layer.** Tiered chat agents handle pre-application Q&A, onboarding journeys, and post-issue customer support. Human-in-the-loop escalation for any regulated advice surface. (Implementation: `ChatAgent`, `ChatConversation`, `ChatMessage`, `ai_agent_router.rb` – verify against current code before pitching.)
- **Operations & admin.** Internal admin agents draft summaries, flag exceptions, and prepare review packs for human sign-off. Cuts ops headcount per A\$ AUM.

- **Marketing & content.** Multi-jurisdictional content (US/AU/NZ/UK) regenerated and tailored without per-region content teams.
- **Customer service triage.** First-line classification, sentiment, priority routing – humans handle resolution; AI handles routing.
- **Investment management ops.** Portfolio rebalancing alerts, anomaly detection, reporting pack generation. Investment *decisions* remain rules-based / human-reviewed; AI handles the surrounding workflow.

The unit-economics consequence (this is what VCs care about)

Operating cost per A\$ AUM at scale [insert latest model output]. The relevant comp is not "another mortgage lender" – it's "what would this business look like if we were a 200-person specialty insurer? We're not, because the AI ops layer absorbs that headcount."

What we don't claim (state this explicitly in pitches)

- AI does not generate credit-underwriting edge – that's Futureproof's proprietary financial model, deterministic math.
- AI does not shorten ASIC / FCA licensing timelines.
- AI does not replace the wholesale funder / warehouse facility need.
- AI does not produce investment alpha – investment policy is rules-based, transparent, and auditable.

This is the realistic AI story. It will hold up to a sharp partner asking "*so what does the AI actually do?*" – which is the question that kills 80% of AI-pitched deals in 2026.

Phase 0 – Pre-launch (Weeks 1-3)

You raise nothing in this phase. You build the machine.

Materials to finalise

- ☐ 1-page teaser – **two variants:** FO (human-story-led), VC (market-structure-led)
- ☐ 15-slide deck – **two variants:** shared core; FO version emphasises asset class + run-off; VC version emphasises market structure, **AI-native operating model (with concrete examples + cost-per-A\$-AUM number)**, defensibility, expansion roadmap, exit comps, and the honest-disclosure block
- ☐ **AI architecture one-pager** (VC pack only) – diagram of the agent layers, what's automated vs human-reviewed, with a clear line on what AI does *not* do (no AI-washing – see honest disclosure)

item 7)

- ☐ Financial model – clean, single sheet of assumptions; Futureproof's proprietary financial model as appendix
- ☐ Data room – corp docs, regulatory status, IP, model, references
- ☐ FAQ – both versions; VC version covers the 6 honest-disclosure objections explicitly
- ☐ Reference list – 3-5 callable references (ASIC contact, super fund exec, financial advisor, technical reviewer of the model, customer if any)

Target list build (`target_list.md`)

- Tier 1: Single-family offices – named principals
- Tier 2: Multi-family offices / wealth platforms – relationship managers
- Tier 3: Strategic backups (super funds, Challenger, bank ventures)
- **Tier 4 (new): fintech / insurtech-specialist VCs – named partners, not generic firms**

Warm intro graph (most critical pre-work)

- ☐ Export LinkedIn 1st-degree connections to CSV
- ☐ Cross-reference against Tier 1 (FOs) and Tier 4 (VCs)
- ☐ For every target with no path: identify a 2nd-degree route, name the bridging connector
- ☐ **Goal: warm-intro path to ~70% of Tier 1 and ~50% of Tier 4 before opening Phase 1**

Structure decisions (settled)

- ☒ **Round structure: SAFE.** Post-money, uncapped, 30% discount to Series A 2028 (discount reduces progressively), USD \$1M minimum, MFN, side letter for follow-on / pro-rata, no lead, rolling close.
- ☐ Confirm ESVCLP eligibility status for the AUD parallel sub-tranche (same SAFE terms, AUD-settled). 10% non-refundable tax offset + CGT exemption for qualifying AU investors. Available, not central.
- ☐ Engage AU venture lawyer (Gilbert + Tobin, K&L Gates, Hall & Wilcox) for SAFE template + side-letter template.
- ☐ Sub-USD \$1M cheques: not accepted (USD \$1M minimum is a hard floor under the SAFE terms).

Phase 1 – Soft sounding (Weeks 4-7)

Goal: 8-10 conversations that are *not* pitches. They're "we're 4-6 weeks from formal raise, would value your input on the structure" calls.

Who to target in this phase

- 2-3 ex-financial-services operators (former Challenger / Macquarie / AMP exec types) – brutal but accurate
- 2-3 wealth platform relationship managers (Crestone, Koda, Mutual Trust, JBWere)
- 1-2 family office principals you have strong warm intros to – candidate anchors
- **2-3 fintech-specialist VC partners (Tier 4)** – frame as thesis-validation, not pitch. They will sharpen your partner-memo arguments before you face a real partner meeting.

Decision gate at end of Phase 1

At least 2 credible anchor candidates (any source: FO, VC, or strategic)?

-  Yes → Phase 2
-  No → don't open the round. Stay in Phase 1 another 3-4 weeks.

Phase 2 – Anchor hunt (Weeks 6-14)

Goal: lock one early-conviction SAFE at ≥ USD \$1M (the round minimum). Early-conviction investor can come from any track. Their cheque captures the highest discount tier and signals to followers – without it, the rolling close stalls.

FO anchor path

See `target_list.md` Tier 1 (single FOs) and Tier 2 (multi-FOs / wealth platforms). Realistically you'll get warm intros to 4-6 Tier 1s – that's enough. Tier 2 platforms are the highest-leverage conversations: one yes = pre-vetted access to dozens of underlying principals.

VC anchor path

A Tier-A specialist VC anchor changes the round dynamic – adds operational signal, opens follow-on conversations for Series A, attracts other institutional money. **It also adds VC-style pressure on growth metrics from day one** – accept that knowingly.

If a Tier-A VC engages seriously: run their process **in parallel** with FO conversations. **Do not pause FO outreach to wait for a VC.** Note that the round is a SAFE on standard terms – there is no term sheet to

negotiate. A VC who wants different terms is signalling a Series A conversation, not a SAFE conversation; surface that early.

Strategic parallel track

Challenger / TAL / MLC Life / Generation Life – exploratory only. *"We'd value your perspective on the market."* You're not selling, you're scouting. Don't share the model.

Decision gate at end of Phase 2

First SAFE signed at ≥ USD \$1M?

-  Yes → Phase 3
 -  No → pause. Don't bleed momentum running a rolling close with zero signed SAFEs on the books. Reassess thesis or audience.
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Phase 3 – Rolling close (Weeks 14-20)

Once the first SAFE is signed, run a structured rolling close:

- First investor's name (with permission) used in next-investor outreach → social proof
- Push through 1-2 wealth platforms simultaneously
- The decreasing-discount mechanic creates the urgency – no need for artificial "soft close" tactics
- USD \$1M is the SAFE minimum cheque – no smaller cheques accepted
- Reserve room for a strategic add (super fund / Challenger / fintech-specialist VC) if a strong fit emerges

Cadence target: 4-6 first meetings/week, 60-80% second-meeting conversion if pitch is right.

Decision gate at end of Phase 3

Substantive SAFE momentum (multiple SAFEs in, discount tier stepped at least once)?

-  Yes → Phase 4
 -  No → extend window. **Do not change the SAFE terms** – signals weakness, breaks MFN.
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Phase 4 – Close (Weeks 20-24)

- Legal: SAFE template signed → side letter (where relevant) → recorded against cap table for conversion at Series A

- ASIC notifications, ESVCLP filings if applicable
- Investor onboarding pack (quarterly reporting cadence; no board seats granted at SAFE stage)

Decision gate at end of Phase 4

Money in the bank?

Honest tradeoffs (read these before starting)

1. **Family-office-led rounds are slow.** 6 months, not 3. Burn rate planning assumes this.
 2. **USD \$1M is the SAFE minimum** – keeps the SAFE pool clean and the cap-table-at-conversion manageable. No nominee/SPV needed for sub-cap cheques because there are none.
 3. **You may end up with passive money.** FOs rarely add operational value the way VCs claim to. Series A still needs an institutional lead – don't burn VC bridges. **This is the #1 reason for the dual-track:** a fintech-specialist VC on the cap table at this round materially improves Series A optionality.
 4. **Discretion is currency for FOs.** Don't name FO investors publicly without explicit permission.
 5. **VCs and SAFE rounds.** VCs accustomed to leading priced rounds will sometimes push for terms outside the SAFE template (governance seats, observer rights, special economics). The standard answer is no – the round is a SAFE on standard terms; bespoke economics break MFN. A VC who insists is signalling a Series A conversation, not a SAFE conversation.
 6. **A "no" is rarely real.** Quarterly update list – ~30% of FOs and ~20% of VCs come back next round.
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What NOT to do

- **✗** Cold-email any Tier 1 single FO (burns the contact for 12 months)
- **✗** Send any teaser with placeholders still in it
- **✗** Pitch Tier-C generalist VCs – wrong product, wrong stage, burns future bridges
- **✗** Approach Challenger before the anchor strategy is clear
- **✗** Pause FO outreach to wait for a VC process
- **✗** Hide the honest-disclosure block from VCs – leading with it is the differentiator
- **✗** Overclaim the AI angle. No "AI-driven underwriting", no "AI generates alpha", no "AI replaces compliance". State what AI does, state what it doesn't, and walk away from any partner who only engages on the inflated version.
- **✗** Run a VC-led process as the primary track – wrong product/stage. VCs are the parallel track, not the lead.

- **✗** Change the SAFE terms mid-round (breaks MFN; signals weakness)

What to do this week

1. [] Confirm ESVCLP eligibility status (or apply)
2. [] Read `target_list.md` ; fill warm-intro paths for FOs and VCs
3. [] Edit `teaser.md` (FO) – replace placeholders, refine voice
4. [] Review `teaser_vc.md` and refine voice for fintech-specialist partners
5. [] Identify 8-10 names for soft-sounding (Phase 1) – including 2-3 fintech VC partners
6. [] Engage AU venture lawyer for SAFE template + side-letter template
7. [] Set up CRM (Affinity / Streak / Sheet) – track every contact
8. [] **Draft the AI architecture one-pager** – list every place AI is doing work today, with the honest line on what it doesn't do. Verify claims against current code in `app/services/ai_agent_router.rb` and the `ChatAgent` family before publishing.

Tracking metrics (review weekly)

Metric	Target
Warm intros requested this week	5+
First meetings booked	3+
First → second meeting conversion	60%+
Early-conviction candidates active (FO + VC + strategic)	2+
First SAFE signed	≥ USD \$1M
Substantive momentum (after Phase 3)	Multiple SAFEs in; discount tier stepped at least once
Round substantively complete (Phase 4)	Capital drawn under rolling close